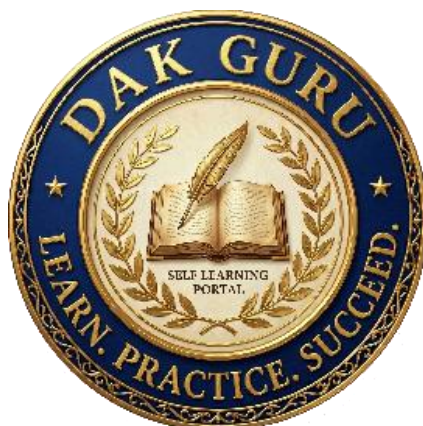


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(DNK) — Post Office Export Facilitation Centre

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Edition: June 2026 | Updated with latest DoP orders, PIB releases & tariff revisions

DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate recent changes, amendments, orders, circulars and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Operational figures (number of centres, country coverage, tariffs and discount slabs) are revised periodically by the Department of Posts. Readers and aspirants are strongly advised to verify the latest position from official sources — the DNK portal (dnk.cept.gov.in), India Post (indiapost.gov.in), PIB releases and Departmental circulars — before relying on any figure for operational or examination purposes.

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Note: This edition has been reviewed and updated against the latest available official and primary sources as of June 2026. Figures that the Department revises periodically (centres, country coverage, tariffs, discount slabs) are flagged in the text — please re-verify them close to your examination date.

1. Introduction & Policy Background

The Government of India provides comprehensive export facilities through post offices to small traders, artisans, craftsmen, weavers and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs). The Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra (DNK) — literally “Post Office Export (Facilitation) Centre” — is an initiative of the Department of Posts (DoP) that helps such exporters move their merchandise abroad by enabling online documentation of shipments together with hand-holding support at the counter.

Before DNK, commercial export articles were accepted only at counters / International Business Centres (IBCs) set up in designated Foreign Post Offices (FPOs), and only through manual filing of the Postal Bill of Export (PBE). Exporters had to bring articles physically to the FPO, where Customs allotted a PBE number before booking, and then claim tax refunds using the PBE signed by Customs. With the DNK software, customers can now file the PBE online and get export shipments booked at designated DNKs / IBCs close to them.

Source: Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for DNK, Ver. 1.1, File No. CF-4/2/2020-CF dated 15.09.2022, Department of Posts (IR & GB Division), para 1.

The initiative was launched to promote e-commerce exports through post offices with ease in booking and transmission, electronic filing of the PBE, and online Customs clearance, while ensuring visibility and transparency throughout the process. It aims to boost rural exports by supporting small-scale exporters and promoting local products, in alignment with the “One District – One Product (ODOP)” initiative, and to help convert India into an export hub by improving the ease of doing business.

Source: DoP Office Memorandum, F. No. 71/61/2022-CF dated 04.08.2023 (India Post tie-ups with e-marketplaces for e-commerce exporters through DNK).

IN ONE LINE

DNK = a single-window facility on the portal dnk.cept.gov.in that lets an exporter file the Postal Bill of Export online, book the article at a nearby Post Office, and obtain Customs clearance and IGST refund — without visiting a Foreign Post Office for documentation.

2. Legal & Regulatory Framework

Exports through post are processed within a framework of Customs and postal law. An aspirant should be able to place DNK within this framework:

Postal Export (Electronic Declaration and Processing) Regulations — These Customs regulations enable the electronic declaration and processing of goods exported by post, which is the legal basis for filing the PBE electronically (instead of manually) and for paperless Customs clearance at the FPO.

Customs Act, 1962 — Goods exported by post are “goods” under the Customs Act; the Let Export Order (LEO) granted by the proper officer of Customs is the legal permission for export. The PBE is the shipping document used for assessment and for claiming IGST refund.

IGST Act, 2017 & GST Rules — Exports are “zero-rated supplies”. The exporter either exports under a Letter of Undertaking (LUT) / bond without payment of IGST, or pays IGST and claims a refund. The DNK portal’s integration with Customs and PFMS automates the IGST refund where IGST has been paid.

Foreign Trade (Development & Regulation) Act, 1992 — Administered by the DGFT; an exporter must hold a valid Import Export Code (IEC) issued by the DGFT to export commercially.

Universal Postal Union (UPU) Convention — International postal exchange, the customs declaration forms (CN 22 / CN 23) and the compensation/indemnity scheme for international articles flow from UPU rules, as adopted by India Post.

CURRENCY NOTE

Section numbers, regulation titles and refund mechanics under GST/Customs are amended from time to time. The points above describe the framework in force as understood up to **mid-2026**. For any statutory citation in an examination answer, verify the current text on the CBIC (cbic.gov.in), DGFT (dgft.gov.in) and India Post portals.

3. Overview of Operations & Coverage

- More than 1,000 Dak Ghar Niryat Kendras are operational across India. The Department’s own communications use the phrase “over 1,000” centres; the precise number rises as new centres are notified, so it should be quoted as “over 1,000” rather than a fixed figure.

Source: PIB Delhi press release dated 17.09.2024, “Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra Expands Export Services with Automated IGST Refund...” (PRID 2055743).

Products can be exported through several international mail products, each with its own coverage and weight limit. The figures below are indicative of the position published by

India Post; country counts are revised periodically and should be re-verified before quoting:

Product	Coverage (countries)	Max. weight	Tracking
International EMS (Speed Post)	106	35 kg	Yes
International Air Parcel	213 / 219*	20 kg	Yes
International Registered (Letter/Parcel)	213	2 kg	Yes
ITPS (Tracked Packet Service)	see note	2 kg → 5 kg*	Yes

*Source: India Post — International Services page (indiapost.gov.in) and DNK workshop material. *Air Parcel destinations are stated as 213 on the International Services page and 219 in some EMS/letter-post contexts; treat the exact count as variable by product and date.*

VERIFIED UPDATE — Tariff Cut & ITPS Expansion (w.e.f. 1 April 2025)

The Department of Posts cut its international tariffs by **up to 49% with effect from 1 April 2025** to reduce logistics cost and improve the competitiveness of Indian exporters.

Five new ITPS destinations were added — **Bulgaria, Kazakhstan, Mexico, Uruguay and Zimbabwe** — and the ITPS weight limit was raised to **5 kg for 29 destinations** (ITPS was originally a 2 kg product). ITPS tracking is not available for a few destinations such as Australia, Germany, USA, Canada, Austria, Belgium, Israel, Norway, Sweden and Denmark in earlier service notes.

Source: Department of Posts advisory as circulated by the Council for Leather Exports, dated 28.04.2025; DNK workshop material on product features.

4. Key Features of Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra

- No need to bring product samples to the Foreign Post Office (FPO).
- No need for manual filing of the Postal Bill of Export (PBE) — it is filed electronically on the portal.
- Supporting documents such as invoices, certificates and licences can be uploaded on the portal.
- No need for the presence of a Customs House Agent (CHA) / Customs officer at the time of booking; the PBE is downloaded from the portal after Customs clearance and dispatch.

- Notifications for any query raised, or documents requested, by Customs are received on the portal, and additional documents can be uploaded there itself to take the process forward.
- Packaging facility (and, where provided, strapping / wrapping machines) available at DNKs.
- Pick-up facility for eligible bulk volumes (free pick-up subject to eligibility — see Section 14).
- Minimal documentation; KYC uploaded once on the DNK is visible to Customs at the FPO.
- Tracking and tracing facility, and provision for lodging complaints online.
- Self-booking facility through the portal, and volume-based discounts for contractual customers.

Source: DoP Office Memorandum F. No. 71/61/2022-CF dated 04.08.2023; SOP Ver. 1.1; DNK workshop material.

5. International Mail Products Used at DNK

DNK handles four broad international accountable-mail products. Knowing the differences is frequently tested:

EMS / International Speed Post (Express Mail Service) — The fastest service for documents and merchandise worldwide; up to 35 kg; tracking available; eligible for Book Now Pay Later (BNPL), advance payment, volume discount and free pick-up. Customs declaration: CN 23 for merchandise.

International Air Parcel — For goods up to 20 kg; tracking available; volume discount and free pick-up available; advance payment facility (no BNPL). Customs declaration: CN 23.

International Registered (Letter / Small Packet) — For documents and small packets up to 2 kg; tracking available; free pick-up for contractual customers. Customs declaration: CN 22.

ITPS (International Tracked Packet Service) — An economical, tracked service designed for small e-commerce sellers; originally up to 2 kg (now up to 5 kg for 29 destinations); competitive rates; ideal for samples. Customs declaration: CN 22 (and CN 23 / harmonized label for ITPS to USA).

MEMORY HOOK

Speed & weight → EMS (35 kg). Bulk goods → Air Parcel (20 kg). Cheap & tracked small packets → ITPS. Documents/small packets → Registered. **BNPL is available only for EMS**; the other three offer advance-payment facility.

Source: DNK workshop material on product features (EMS/Air Parcel/Registered/ITPS); India Post International Services.

6. End-to-End Process Flow (SOP Ver. 1.1)

The official SOP sets out the commercial-booking process at a DNK in clear steps. The flow below is condensed from that SOP:

- **Registration & profile:** The customer registers on dnk.cept.gov.in, logs in, updates the profile and uploads business KYC — IEC, AD Code, GSTIN, LUT, etc. (IEC and GSTIN are mandatory at present).
- **Article entry:** Article booking is done either by data entry or by bulk upload using an Excel template; document(s) for the article (licences, certificates, invoices) are uploaded.
- **Labels:** The customer prints the CN 23 or harmonized label (harmonized label in case of ITPS for USA) and affixes/presents it with the article. The PBE form can be downloaded only after Customs clearance and dispatch.
- **Presentation at counter:** The article is presented at the DNK / IBC counter (or picked up, for eligible bulk volumes).
- **Counter induction:** The counter Postal Assistant inducts the article in CSI Point-of-Sale (Business Services → Portal Induction → Other Induction) by scanning the barcode in “Reference Number” and pressing F8; obtains KYC, checks/modifies weight, and takes payment. For BNPL/advance-payment bulk customers, one-time validation of Customer ID / Contract ID is done from CEPT.
- **Dispatch to FPO:** The article is bagged and dispatched to the mapped FPO. Until system-level blocking of uncleared Customs articles is enabled, DNKs close a direct, category-wise bag clearly marked “PBE ARTICLES” on the bag label.
- **Customs at FPO:** At the FPO, PBE bags are opened before Customs; Customs fetches article details through the Customs portal after induction in CSI-PoS, and either approves or holds the article on examination.

- **Query handling:** If Customs raises a query (e.g. additional document/information), a notification is sent through the portal; the customer replies through the portal. Customs then clears the detained article or cancels the export.
- **LEO & PBE download:** On clearance and dispatch to the destination country, Customs grants the Let Export Order (LEO), and the PBE form becomes available to the customer under “Forms Download” in the portal.

Source: SOP for DNK, Ver. 1.1, File No. CF-4/2/2020-CF dated 15.09.2022, paras 1.1.1–1.1.21. (“CSI” = Core System Integrator; “IPVS” = India Post Visibility System.)

7. The DNK Customer Portal – Step by Step

7.1 Registration

- **Access the Portal:** Open a recommended browser (Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox or Microsoft Edge) and visit <https://dnk.cept.gov.in/customers.web/>
- **Register Account:** Click “Don’t have an account? Register Now”.
- Fill in the User ID, e-mail ID, mobile number and password.
- Complete registration by entering the OTP received on the registered mobile number.
- After validation, a confirmation e-mail is sent and registration is complete.

7.2 Login

- **Login Process:** Open the portal, enter the username and password (or mobile number), request an OTP, enter it, and click LOG IN.

7.3 Profile Management (Manage Profile)

- Access “Manage Profile” from the user menu.
- **Fill in business details:** Import Export Code (IEC), AD Code, GSTIN, and Letter of Undertaking (LUT) / Bond details. IEC and GSTIN are mandatory.
- Update and validate the IEC — validation automatically updates the profile address.
- Update the LUT document at the beginning of each financial year.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, paras 1.1.1–1.1.5; “Step-by-step process of DNK Customer Portal”, Department of Posts.

8. Article Booking in Detail

8.1 Individual Booking via Data Entry

- **Type of Items:** EMS (Merchandise), EMS (Document), Registered Small Packets, Air Parcel, Registered Letter, ITPS.
- **Category of Items:** Commercial Sample, Returned Goods, Sale of Goods, Others.
- **Gross Weight:** weight of the parcel with packaging (packaging should not exceed about 10% of the primary content).
- **Value:** to be entered in INR.
- **SDR:** the system calculates this automatically. SDR (Special Drawing Rights) is the IMF unit used to fix the international compensation/indemnity limits (see Section 18).
- **Instruction in case of non-delivery:** Abandoned, RTS-Priority (Return to Sender – Priority), or RTS-Non Priority.
- **Licence:** manufacturing/other licence, where the item requires one.
- **Certificate:** a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the competent authority. Example: to send drugs, an NOC from the Assistant Drugs Controller (ADC) is required.
- **Select PBE:** the appropriate Postal Bill of Export (PBE-III or PBE-IV for DNK — see Section 9).
- **DOP Customer ID:** the default Customer ID (3000048090) is displayed by the portal for all non-contractual customers.
- **Sender / Recipient details:** to be entered as required.
- **IOSS (Import One-Stop Shop):** entered against the “Sender’s Customs reference” number; required where the export is to countries of the European Union (it simplifies VAT collection on low-value B2C goods into the EU).
- **Piece Details:** details of each piece — invoice number, date, gross weight, net weight.

8.2 Bulk Upload

- Use the bulk-upload feature to enter multiple articles at once using the prescribed Excel template — useful for e-commerce sellers booking many packets.

8.3 Documents Upload

- **Upload KYC documents** such as IEC, AD Code, GSTIN, LUT, Aadhaar, etc.

8.4 Forms Download & History

- Download forms — CN 23, harmonized label, PBE forms, invoices and address labels — from the portal, and view the history of booked articles and transactions.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, paras 1.1.6–1.1.8; DNK Customer Portal data-entry fields.

9. Postal Bill of Export (PBE) — Classification & Rules

The Postal Bill of Export is the shipping document used for export by post; it is assessed by Customs and is the document on which the exporter claims the IGST refund. Its form depends on how it is filed (manual or electronic) and on the type of export (e-commerce or other):

PBE Filing Method	Export Type	PBE Form Type
Manual	e-Commerce	PBE-I
	Other than e-Commerce	PBE-II
Electronic	e-Commerce	PBE-III
	Other than e-Commerce	PBE-IV

KEY RULES ON THE PBE

DNK uses **PBE-III (e-commerce)** and **PBE-IV (non e-commerce)**, because filing at DNK is electronic.

The PBE number is generated automatically by the system on submission. **Printing of the PBE form and the Let Export Order is NOT allowed prior to Customs clearance**; the PBE can be downloaded only after clearance and dispatch.

Before clearance the customer may print the USPS harmonized label / CN 22 / CN 23, the address slip and the invoice.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, para 1.1.8 and 1.1.21; Mumbai Customs Zone-III guidance on PBE-III/PBE-IV; DNK portal note.

10. CN 22 vs CN 23 Customs Declarations

Every international article carries a Universal Postal Union (UPU) customs declaration. Which form applies depends mainly on the value and weight of the contents:

Feature	CN 22	CN 23
Form type	Small adhesive label	Full-page form (in a clear pouch)

Feature	CN 22	CN 23
Used when value is	Up to 300 SDR	Above 300 SDR
Typical weight	Up to ~2 kg (small packet)	Heavier / higher-value items
Detail required	Brief description & value	Itemised description, HS code, etc.
Typical DNK use	ITPS, Registered small packets	EMS merchandise, Air Parcel

Source: UPU Convention thresholds as adopted by India Post; India Post customs-declaration guidance. The 300 SDR / ~2 kg threshold is the standard rule; destination countries may apply stricter limits.

PRACTICAL TIP (Commercial Exports)

For a commercial sale, never mark the article as “Gift” and never under-declare value — this is treated as customs fraud and can lead to seizure. Attach a commercial invoice on the exterior and state the reason for export (e.g. “sale” or “sample”). For ITPS to the USA, a harmonized label is generated on the portal.

11. Discount Structure for Customers at DNK

IMPORTANT — TWO DISCOUNT STRUCTURES EXIST IN DEPARTMENTAL MATERIAL

The detailed slab tables below (Tables 11.1 and 11.2) appear in DNK customer-facing material and match the Department’s graded international commercial-discount structure. **Separately, some DoP workshop slides show a SIMPLER structure** — EMS: Nil up to ₹2,00,000; 5% (₹2–1,00,000); 10% (₹10,00,001–5,00,000); 15% above ₹50,00,000 — and ITPS: Nil up to ₹1,00,000; 5% (₹1–2,00,000); 10% above ₹2,00,000. Because the two differ, **confirm the slab currently in force from the latest DoP circular / DNK portal before relying on a specific figure.**

Source: Detailed slabs: DNK customer material. Simplified slabs: “Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra Workshop” presentation (DoP). Variance flagged in good faith — not yet reconciled against a single dated master circular.

11.1 EMS (Merchandise) — Detailed Slabs

Monthly Revenue (INR, excl. taxes)	Discount for contractual customers incl. bulk (A)	Additional DNK discount — contractual & non-contractual (B)
Up to 25,000	0%	1%
25,001 to 1,00,000	3%	1%
1,00,001 to 5,00,000	6%	1%

Monthly Revenue (INR, excl. taxes)	Discount for contractual customers incl. bulk (A)	Additional DNK discount — contractual & non-contractual (B)
5,00,001 to 20,00,000	9%	1%
20,00,001 to 50,00,000	12%	1%
50,00,001 & above	13%	1%

11.2 ITPS (International Tracked Packet Service) — Detailed Slabs

Monthly Revenue (INR, excl. taxes)	Discount for contractual customers incl. bulk (A)	Additional DNK discount — contractual & non-contractual (B)
Up to 25,000	0%	2%
25,001 to 1,00,000	4%	2%
1,00,001 to 2,00,000	6%	2%
2,00,001 to 5,00,000	9%	2%
5,00,001 to 20,00,000	12%	2%
20,00,001 to 40,00,000	14%	2%
40,00,001 to 75,00,000	16%	2%
75,00,001 & above	18%	2%

CAUTION — Tariff Currency

The discount slabs are applied on the base tariff. The **base international tariff itself was cut by up to 49% with effect from 1 April 2025**. Always compute the final amount on the current base tariff using the official India Post postage calculator, and confirm the discount percentage in force.

12. Eligibility for Discount

- The customer must be registered as an Advance Customer or BNPL (Book Now, Pay Later) customer for the international accountable-mail product (EMS / Registered / ITPS).
- The customer must provide booking data in soft copy where the PBE is filled manually.

- Where data is not provided in soft copy, the discount is half of the rates above.
- All articles booked through the DNK portal are eligible for the discount, since the data is provided by the exporter in soft copy.
- Any claim of the customer shall not be adjusted against the advance payment / dues of a BNPL customer.

13. Contractual & Bulk Customers

Definition of a Contractual Bulk Customer

S. No.	Monthly Revenue, excl. taxes (EMS / Air Parcel / Registered Letter / ITPS)	Amount (INR)
1	Single Location	50,000
2	Multiple Location	2,00,000

- A contractual customer may register with any International Business Centre / DNK designated by the competent authority, irrespective of the office / residential address.
- Contractual EMS / Speed Post & ITPS customers booking from multiple locations are allowed consolidation of accounts under the National Account Facility at all booking locations, for calculation of discount, billing and payment at the nodal office.
- **Approving authority – credit facility / National Account Facility:** PMG for all cases within his region; CPMG for all other cases.
- **Approving authority – advance deposit / payment at booking:** Divisional Head for Single Location; for Multiple Location – PMG (within his region) and CPMG (all other cases).
- **Signing / Designation authority:** Divisional Head.

14. Free Pick-Up

Eligibility Criteria

S. No.	Monthly Revenue, excl. taxes (EMS / Air Parcel / Registered Letter / ITPS)	Amount (INR)
1	Single Location	50,000
2	Multiple Location	2,00,000

- Free pick-up is limited to the municipal area to which the booking centre belongs, or within a radius of 20 km from the centre.
- Heads of Circles (HOCs) are empowered to extend the jurisdiction to provide free pick-up beyond the municipal limit, in consultation with the CIFA (Circle Internal Finance Adviser).
- Pick-up for eligible volumes is provided in case of bulk bookings, and the articles are brought to the booking office.

15. Credit Facility & Bank Guarantee

- CPMG / PMG is the approving authority for the credit facility.
- On approval, the customer must furnish a security deposit in the form of a Bank Guarantee.
- The Bank Guarantee must be issued by a Nationalised or Scheduled Bank and must equal the anticipated postage of three billing cycles.
- The amount is reviewed quarterly by the authority who signed the agreement.
- If monthly business exceeds the Bank Guarantee amount, a Bank Guarantee for the additional amount must be obtained.
- Only an Undertaking (in the prescribed proforma) is required from Government Organisations / Nationalised or Scheduled Banks / Public Sector Units, in lieu of a Bank Guarantee.

16. Advance Deposit / Payment at Booking

- Customers wishing to avail the advance-deposit facility, or pay at the time of booking, must sign the prescribed agreement and present consignments only at identified centres.
- **Single Location:** open a deposit account with a minimum of Rs. 5,000 per product (separate account for each of EMS / Parcel / Registered / ITPS).
- **Multiple Locations:** minimum advance deposit of Rs. 50,000 per product.

17. Billing & Penalties

S. No.	Billing Cycle	Date of Bill Generation	Last Date of Payment (BNPL Customer)
1	15 days / fortnightly	22nd of the month	7th of the following month
		7th of the following month	15th of the month of bill generation
2	30 days / monthly	7th of the following month	30th / 31st of the month of bill generation

Penalties

- On failure to pay by the due date, a penalty of 12% per annum (calculated daily) on the bill amount is imposed, reckoned from the bill date.
- No booking of international mail is allowed from the defaulting customer after one month from the due date, until all pending bills with penalty are paid in full.
- On non-payment even after two months from the bill date, the designated authority initiates action to invoke the Bank Guarantee to recover the outstanding amount.
- This period may be extended for a Central / State Government organisation by the concerned CPMG, if deemed fit.
- The Department may accept booking from such a defaulting customer on full pre-payment of postage, as a new customer, per prevailing guidelines.

18. Compensation / Indemnity for International Mail

Compensation for loss, total theft or total damage of international accountable articles is fixed in SDR (Special Drawing Rights), under rules adopted from the UPU. These limits are commonly tested. The SDR rate is revised by the Directorate on an annual basis:

Article	Compensation on loss / total theft / total damage
International Registered article	Value of contents or 30 SDR, whichever is less, plus the postage paid
International Registered M-Bag	150 SDR (plus postage, as applicable)
International Parcel	40 SDR + 4.5 SDR per kg, or value of contents, whichever is less, subject to a ceiling of 130 SDR, plus the postage paid

Article	Compensation on loss / total theft / total damage
EMS (Speed Post) — Merchandise	Value of contents or 130 SDR, whichever is less, plus the postage paid
EMS (Speed Post) — Documents	Limited only to the postage paid

Source: India Post — “Revised compensation policy for International articles (Registered, Parcels, EMS and ITPS)”; India Post International Services page. *SDR rate revised annually by the Directorate.

NOTE ON PARTIAL LOSS & ITPS

For partial loss / partial damage / partial theft, compensation is limited to the value of the lost or damaged content and cannot exceed the corresponding “total loss” amount; in such cases the postage paid is not refunded. ITPS is a tracked but economical packet service; verify its specific indemnity from the current compensation circular, as it is treated under the small-packet/registered category.

19. Handholding, Manpower & Training (SOP)

19.1 Handholding by the Postal Assistant

The Postal Assistant deployed at a DNK is expected to:

- Assist customers in registration on the Customs portal and in creating a profile (User ID / Password).
- Guide exporters on filing the PBE and on generating an IEC.
- Assist in preparing the Excel sheet of details and uploading it with invoices/certificates.
- Assist in printing the CN form / harmonized label generated on the portal.
- Educate exporters about Government facilities, schemes, incentives and tax benefits for commercial exports.

19.2 Manpower Deployment (Categories A / B / C)

Category	Minimum staff to be identified & trained	Dedicated to DNK at any time
A	4 efficient Postal Assistants + 1 Supervisor	2 persons
B	3 efficient Postal Assistants + 1 Supervisor	1 person

Category	Minimum staff to be identified & trained	Dedicated to DNK at any time
C	2 efficient Postal Assistants + 1 Supervisor	1 person

Circles are to identify at least double the number of Postal Assistants/MTS actually required, and train them, so that DNKs can function even during the absence of regular staff due to leave/training/transfer. Only trained PAs should be deployed to manage DNKs.

19.3 Training Modules

Training is imparted by the IR & GB Division of the Directorate and covers: product information of international mails; restricted and prohibited items; addressing / labeling standards; Customs declaration requirements and related information; and export benefits. Regular local training is recommended in consultation with the Federation of Indian Export Organisations (FIEO), district Export Development Centres and exporters' bodies.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, paras 1.2, 2 and 3.

20. Packaging Solutions (SOP)

- **Exporter's own packaging:** permitted; if sub-standard (irregular shape, not meeting make-up rules for international articles), the customer is guided to a standard packaging solution at the DNK.
- **E-Marketplace (EMP) packaging:** EMPs may supply their standard packing products directly to sellers; EMPs registered as Bulk Customers may also be allowed to supply packaging inventory at DNKs for their registered sellers at the time of booking.
- **DoP standard packaging:** in line with the Parcel Packaging Policy (Parcel Directorate letter No. 27-08/2021-PD dated 10.02.2022), Circles procure/source packaging material as per demand and make it available to exporters under retail post at DNKs.
- **Strapping / wrapping machine:** provided to DNKs for shipments needing an additional layer of safety; specifications circulated separately.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, para 4 (4.1–4.5).

21. Mail Arrangement & Transmission (SOP)

- A DNK in Category A closes a direct bag for its mapped Office of Exchange (OE) / Foreign Post Office (FPO).
- From other DNKs, dispatches to the FPO/OE in principle follow the existing mail arrangement; however, a DNK handling more than 15 articles/packets per day or 5 kg of weight (monthly average) should review its arrangement and close a direct bag to the mapped FPO to improve efficiency.
- **48-hour rule:** in no case should bags from any DNK take more than 48 hours to reach the mapped FPO.
- Circles should also review the mail arrangement from Sub-Foreign Post Offices (SFPOs) to FPOs/OEs so that mail reaches OEs the next day.
- Until system-level blocking of uncleared Customs articles is enabled, all DNKs close direct, category-wise bags to mapped FPOs clearly marked “PBE ARTICLES” on the bag label.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, para 5 (5.1–5.4).

22. Accounting at DNK (SOP)

There is no change in the accounting process for DNK-booked articles. Accounting begins from the moment the article is inducted in CSI-PoS. One-time validation of the Customer ID / Contract ID of bulk customers (for BNPL / advance-payment facility) is done from CEPT.

Source: SOP Ver. 1.1, paras 1.1.13 and 6.

23. Designated Authority

Office of Posting	Designated Authority
DNK (Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra)	Divisional Head
International Business Centre	Divisional Head
Foreign Post Office	Divisional Head
Post Office	Divisional Head

24. Centres of Excellence for Exports

As part of the vision to transform India Post into a major public logistics organisation — as outlined by the Hon'ble Minister of Finance in the Budget speech — the Department of Posts has announced plans to establish Centres of Excellence for Exports across the country. These are intended to be comprehensive export-facilitation hubs offering cataloguing studios, inventory management and warehousing, training and conference facilities, and dedicated help desks to assist exporters in expanding their global reach.

STATUS NOTE

This is a stated plan / vision linked to the Union Budget announcement. **Treat the scope and roll-out as evolving** — confirm the current operational status from the latest DoP / PIB releases before quoting in an answer.

Source: Council for Leather Exports advisory (28.04.2025) citing the DoP/Budget vision for Centres of Excellence for Exports.

25. Important Full Forms & Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Form / Meaning
DNK	Dak Ghar Niryat Kendra (Post Office Export Facilitation Centre)
PBE	Postal Bill of Export (PBE-III / PBE-IV for DNK)
IEC	Import Export Code (issued by DGFT)
DGFT	Directorate General of Foreign Trade (Ministry of Commerce)
AD Code	Authorised Dealer Code (issued by the bank)
LUT	Letter of Undertaking (GST Department, financial-year-wise)
GSTIN	Goods and Services Tax Identification Number
IGST	Integrated Goods and Services Tax
CTH	Customs Tariff Heading
HS Code	Harmonized System code (for tariff classification)
LEO	Let Export Order (granted by Customs)
FPO / OE	Foreign Post Office / Office of Exchange
SFPO	Sub-Foreign Post Office
IBC	International Business Centre
EMS	Express Mail Service (International Speed Post)

Abbreviation	Full Form / Meaning
ITPS	International Tracked Packet Service
IOSS	Import One-Stop Shop (for exports to the European Union)
BNPL	Book Now, Pay Later
RTS	Return to Sender
SDR	Special Drawing Rights (IMF unit; used for indemnity limits)
NOC	No Objection Certificate
ADC	Assistant Drugs Controller
CHA	Customs House Agent
ICEGATE	Indian Customs Electronic Gateway
ICES	Indian Customs EDI System
PFMS	Public Financial Management System
EDPMS	Export Data Processing & Monitoring System (RBI)
CSI	Core System Integrator (CSI-PoS = Point of Sale)
IPVS	India Post Visibility System
CEPT	Centre for Excellence in Postal Technology
ODOP	One District – One Product
MSME	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
EMP	E-Marketplace
FIEO	Federation of Indian Export Organisations
PMG / CPMG	Postmaster General / Chief Postmaster General
HOC	Head of Circle
CIFA	Circle Internal Finance Adviser

26. Quick Revision — Key Points at a Glance

- **Portal:** dnk.cept.gov.in — single-window, electronic filing of PBE; no FPO visit needed for documentation.
- **Foundational orders:** OM F. No. 71/61/2022-CF dated 04.08.2023; SOP Ver. 1.1, File No. CF-4/2/2020-CF dated 15.09.2022.

- **Integrations:** ICEGATE, ICES, PFMS, EDPMS (RBI) — enabling automated IGST refund (PIB, 17.09.2024).
- **Mandatory KYC:** IEC and GSTIN are mandatory; AD Code, LUT, Aadhaar also uploaded.
- **PBE forms:** Manual → PBE-I (e-Com)/PBE-II (non e-Com); Electronic → PBE-III (e-Com)/PBE-IV (non e-Com). DNK uses PBE-III/PBE-IV.
- **Customs milestone:** PBE downloadable only after Customs grants the LEO and the article is dispatched.
- **Customs forms:** CN 22 up to 300 SDR / ~2 kg; CN 23 above that; harmonized label for ITPS to USA.
- **Default DOP Customer ID:** 3000048090 (non-contractual customers).
- **Contractual bulk threshold / free-pick-up threshold:** ₹50,000 (single location); ₹2,00,000 (multiple locations). Free pick-up within municipal area or 20 km.
- **Bank Guarantee:** three billing cycles' anticipated postage; reviewed quarterly.
- **Advance deposit (minimum):** ₹5,000 per product (single location); ₹50,000 per product (multiple locations).
- **Late-payment penalty:** 12% p.a., calculated daily, from the bill date.
- **Compensation (key):** Registered → 30 SDR; M-Bag → 150 SDR; Parcel → 40 SDR + 4.5 SDR/kg, cap 130 SDR; EMS merchandise → 130 SDR; EMS documents → postage only.
- **Manpower:** Category A/B/C → 4/3/2 PAs + Supervisor (2/1/1 dedicated).
- **Mail rule:** bag to mapped FPO within 48 hours; direct bag if >15 articles/day or >5 kg.
- **Tariff (verified):** DoP international tariffs cut by up to 49% w.e.f. 1 April 2025; ITPS extended to 5 new destinations and up to 5 kg for 29 destinations.

27. Likely Examination Questions

Use these to self-test. (Answers are in the sections indicated.)

- Define DNK and state its objective. Which portal is used? (§1, §3)
- Which PBE form is used at DNK for e-commerce and non-e-commerce exports, and why? (§9)

- List the four international mail products used at DNK with their weight limits. Which one offers BNPL? (§5)
- When is a CN 22 used and when a CN 23? State the value threshold. (§10)
- Name the four systems with which the DNK portal is integrated and the benefit of this integration. (§1, §3)
- State the compensation for loss of (a) an International Registered article, (b) an International Parcel, (c) EMS merchandise. (§18)
- What is the free-pick-up radius, and who may extend it? (§14)
- State the Bank Guarantee requirement and the late-payment penalty. (§15, §17)
- Describe the manpower deployment for Category A/B/C DNKs. (§19)
- What is the maximum permissible time for a bag to reach the mapped FPO? (§21)

Sources, Authorities & Currency Note

This booklet has been reviewed and updated against the latest available official and primary sources as of June 2026. Figures that the Department revises periodically (number of operational centres, country coverage, tariffs, discount slabs and the SDR rate) are flagged in the text; aspirants should re-verify these close to their examination date.

Primary departmental authorities cited

- **SOP for DNK, Ver. 1.1** — File No. CF-4/2/2020-CF dated 15.09.2022, Department of Posts (IR & GB Division). Process, manpower, training, packaging, mail arrangement, accounting.
- **e-Marketplace tie-up OM** — F. No. 71/61/2022-CF dated 04.08.2023 (objective and launch of DNK for e-commerce exporters).
- **PIB Delhi press release** — dated 17.09.2024 (over 1,000 DNKs; ICEGATE/ICES/PFMS/EDPMS integration; automated IGST refund). PRID 2055743.
- **Compensation policy** — India Post “Revised compensation policy for International articles (Registered, Parcels, EMS and ITPS)” and the India Post International Services page.
- **Packaging policy** — Parcel Directorate letter No. 27-08/2021-PD dated 10.02.2022.

Official portals for verification

- **DNK Customer Portal:** dnk.cept.gov.in/customers.web/ (registration, booking, forms).
- **India Post:** indiapost.gov.in (postage calculator, current tariffs, international services).
- **CBIC / Customs:** cbic.gov.in (Postal Export Regulations, Customs Act).
- **DGFT:** dgft.gov.in (Import Export Code / IEC).

— End of Booklet —

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